



Caring for the children

As other young patients look on, hospital corpsman Ronald L. Williams treats a boy with an infected leg in An Tan, during a medical civic action (MEDCAP) visit in June 1966. Williams served with the First Hospital Company, First Marine Division.

Working together

The platoons were strengthened by the complementary skills each side brought to the unit. The CAP Marines, who were on average about 20 years old, brought firepower, training, and also access to American resources such as medevac, artillery, and air support. The local militia, on the other hand, had varying degrees of military prowess—some were veterans of the First Indochina War—but also contributed key local knowledge of terrain and customs, as well as a fierce desire to defend their homes.